

⚡ ACE-Step 1.5 + REAPER: Quick Start Guide

Version: 1.0

Language: English

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🕒 In 15 Minutes: From Zero to Music Generation

What You'll Have After This:

- 🖥️ ACE-Step 1.5 Server running on `http://127.0.0.1:8001`
- 🎵 Modern GUI in REAPER (song language: Vietnamese + English)
- 🎧 First AI-generated music in your timeline

📋 Pre-Requirements Checklist

- ✓ Windows 10/11 (64-bit)
- ✓ REAPER 6.82+ (<https://reaper.fm/download.php>)
- ✓ Git installed (<https://git-scm.com/downloads>)
- ✓ 16GB+ RAM (32GB recommended)
- ✓ GPU: NVIDIA RTX 3060+ (or CPU-only, but slow)
- ✓ 150GB free disk space (for models)
- ✓ Internet connection (500 Mbps recommended)

Check GPU: Open Command Prompt, type:

```
nvidia-smi
```

If you see your GPU, you're good. If not, CPU-only mode (5-10x slower).

🔧 Step 1: Install Backend (5 Minutes)

1.1 Create Folder

```
cd D:\
mkdir ACE-Step-Project
cd ACE-Step-Project
```

1.2 Copy & Run Installer

Copy this file to `D:\ACE-Step-Project\`:

- `install_ace_step_EN.bat` (English)
- or `install_ace_step_VN.bat` (Vietnamese)

Double-click the .bat file

You'll see:

```
[1/5] Checking for Git... ✓ Found
[2/5] Checking for 'uv' package manager... Installing...
[3/5] Downloading ACE-Step-1.5... Cloned
[4/5] Installing Python & Libraries... Done (takes 5-10 min)
[5/5] Creating startup script... Done

INSTALLATION COMPLETE!
```

Result: `D:\ACE-Step-Project\ACE-Step-1.5\` folder created with everything ready.

☒ Step 2: Get Model Checkpoints (Varies)

Option A: Auto-Download (Easiest, 30+ min)

```
cd D:\ACE-Step-Project\ACE-Step-1.5\checkpoints

:: Models will auto-download on first server run
:: (requires 100-150GB space, ~30 min on 100Mbps internet)
```

Option B: Manual Download (If auto fails)

Visit: <https://huggingface.co/ace-step>

Download these 4 folders:

- `acestep-v15-turbo` → Save to `D:\ACE-Step-Project\ACE-Step-1.5\checkpoints\`
- `acestep-v15-base`
- `acestep-5Hz-1m-1.7B`
- `acestep-5Hz-1m-4B`

Expected structure:

```
D:\ACE-Step-Project\ACE-Step-1.5\checkpoints\
├─ acestep-v15-turbo\
├─ acestep-v15-base\
├─ acestep-5Hz-1m-1.7B\
└─ acestep-5Hz-1m-4B\
```

☒ Step 3: Install GUI in REAPER (2 Minutes)

3.1 Copy Script File

Copy `Hosi_ACE_Step_GUI.lua` to:

```
C:\Users\YourName\AppData\Roaming\REAPER\Scripts\
```

3.2 Verify REAPER Can Find It

Open REAPER:

1. **Actions → Show Action List**
2. Search: "Hosi"
3. You should see the script listed

Done! The GUI is ready.

☒ Step 4: Launch Server (3 Minutes)

4.1 Start Server

Open **Command Prompt / Terminal** and run:

```
cd D:\ACE-Step-Project\ACE-Step-1.5

:: Run the launcher (choose one based on language)
ACE_Launcher_Pro_En_full.bat
:: or
ACE_Launcher_Pro_VI_full.bat
```

4.2 Choose Model

```
=====
ACE-STEP 1.5 CONTROL CENTER - V3.1 (ULTIMATE)
=====

[1] TURBO + 1.7B LM (Fast, 8 steps, less accurate)
[2] TURBO + 4B LM (Fast, 8 steps, 95% accurate) ← RECOMMENDED
[3] BASE + 1.7B LM (Slow, 50 steps, best for stem extraction)
[4] BASE + 4B LM (Slow, 50 steps, studio master quality)
[5] EXIT

=> CHOOSE A VERSION (1/2/3/4/5): 2
```

For beginners: Choose **[2]** (fast + good quality)

4.3 Wait for Server to Start

Look for this message:

```
[INFO] Loading config from D:\ACE-Step-1.5\checkpoints\acestep-v15-turbo
[INFO] Loading LM from D:\ACE-Step-1.5\checkpoints\acestep-5Hz-1m-4B
[INFO] CUDA available: True
[INFO] Server running on http://127.0.0.1:8001
```

Don't close this terminal - it's your server running!

🔪 Step 5: Generate Your First Track (5 Minutes)

5.1 Open GUI in REAPER

Open REAPER (if not already open) and:

- Method A:** Script → Hosi_ACE_Step_GUI
- Method B:** Actions → Search "Hosi ACE" → Double-click

You'll see the GUI window pop up.

5.2 Fill In Basic Info

Tab 1: Text-to-Music (should be selected by default)

```
Prompt (Tags):
→ Vietnamese Pop Ballad, Piano, Emotional, Sad, Slow tempo, Clean mixing

Lyrics (Optional):
→ Leave empty for now (or paste lyrics below)
  [Verse 1]
  Em vẫn nhớ lúc anh nói yêu em
  [Chorus]
  Yêu anh mãi mãi

Duration: 15 (seconds)
BPM: 80
Time Signature: 4/4
Key: C Major
Quality: ✓ High Quality (Thinking)
```

5.3 Click Generate

Button: "BẮT ĐẦU TẠO NHẠC" (Start Creating Music)

What happens:

- GUI shows "Processing... ID: xxx"
- Server processes (~30-60 seconds for Base model, ~8-12 seconds for Turbo)
- Status updates: "Completed"
- WAV file automatically inserted into REAPER timeline

📊 Model Comparison Quick Reference

Need	Use	Speed	Quality	Cost (Time)
Draft ideas	Turbo 1.7B	4-8s	80%	Low
Good track	Turbo 4B	8-12s	95%	Low
Extract stems	Base 1.7B	40-60s	85%	Medium
Perfect track	Base 4B	60-120s	99%	High

🖥️ GUI Overview (60 Seconds)

TOP: 🎵 ACE-Step 1.5 Generator ⚙️ Settings (gear icon)

7 TABS (click to switch):

1. Text-to-Music (Create from text)
2. Add Player (Add instruments to track)
3. Remix (Restyle existing audio)
4. Repaint (Redo one section)
5. Voice Extract (Quick stem separation)
6. Stem Extractor (Professional stem extraction)
7. A Cappella Generator (Create vocals only)

CONTROLS (same for all tabs):

- Prompt field (describe the music)
- Lyrics field (optional, for structured songs)
- Duration slider (5-30 seconds)
- BPM (60-180)
- Time Signature (2, 3, 4, 6 beats)
- Key (C, D, E, F, G, A, B + minor versions)
- Advanced Options (seed, steps, method, ADG)
- Quality toggle (High Quality = slower but better)

BUTTONS:

- [Generate] (main action)
- [🎲 Random Prompt] (auto-generate creative prompt)
- [⚙️ Settings] (language, theme, about)

STATUS: Shows "Ready" or "Processing..." or "Completed"

🔗 7 Quick Mode Guides

Mode 1: Text-to-Music (What You Just Did!)

- **Use:** Create music from text description
- **Time:** 8-120s (depends on model & steps)
- **Output:** 1 WAV file

Mode 2: Add Player

- **Use:** Add new instruments to your beat
- **Steps:** Select track → Get Output → Change prompt → Generate
- **Prompt:** "Add Violin, Piano, Strings"

Mode 3: Remix

- **Use:** Completely restyle existing audio
- **Remix Strength:** 0.1 (total change) to 0.9 (subtle change)
- **Example:** Ballad → EDM Remix

Mode 4: Repaint

- **Use:** Redo one section of a track
- **Steps:** Select track → Highlight time section → Change prompt → Generate
- **Result:** Only that section changed

Mode 5: Voice Extract (Fast)

- **Use:** Extract vocals, bass, or drums (quick but imperfect)
- **Time:** 8-12s
- **Output:** 1 stem (vocals, bass, drums, etc.)

Mode 6: Stem Extractor (Professional)

- **Use:** Split track into 3-4 perfect stems
- **Time:** 50s per stem (e.g., 4 stems = 3+ minutes)
- **Output:** Multiple stems in separate tracks

Mode 7: A Cappella Generator

- **Use:** Create vocals with your lyrics (no instruments)
- **Lyrics:** "Required" - paste full song structure
- **Result:** Vocal-only WAV file

🔧 5-Minute Troubleshooting

"WAITING ON API SERVER..." (Won't finish)

Fix:

```
:: Check if server is running
:: Terminal 1 should show "Server running on http://127.0.0.1:8001"

:: If not, restart:
:: Close Terminal 1, run launcher again
```

"Connection Failed"

Fix:

```
:: Verify checkpoints exist
cd D:\ACE-Step-Project\ACE-Step-1.5\checkpoints
dir /s pytorch_model.bin

:: Should see 4 files. If not, download from:
:: https://huggingface.co/ace-step
```

"Process Too Slow"

Fix:

- Use Turbo model instead of Base (8 steps vs 50 steps)
- Reduce duration (10s instead of 30s)
- Close other apps (Chrome, Spotify, etc.)
- Check GPU: nvidia-smi (should show high utilization)

"REAPER Freezes"

Expected: 1-2 second freeze when clicking Generate (normal)

If longer: Use Base model → Advanced Options → reduce Steps from 32 to 20

"File Not Downloaded"

Fix:

```
:: Check disk space
C:\ needs at least 2-3GB free

:: Clear temp folder
cd C:\Users\YourName\AppData\Roaming\REAPER\Scripts\ACE_Step_Temp
del /Q *.*

```

🔧 Pro Tips

- 🔧 **Use specific genre:** "Vinahouse" better than "Electronic"
- 🔧 **Add mood:** "Sad, Emotional" better than just "Pop"
- 🔧 **Specify instruments:** "Piano, Strings, Drums" better than "Instruments"
- 🔧 **Include quality:** "Clean mixing, HiFi" for production tracks
- 🔧 **Lock seed:** Set Seed to specific number to get consistent variations
- 🔧 **High Quality:** Check for longer/better generation (slower)
- 🔧 **Lyrics structure:** Use [Verse 1], [Chorus], [Bridge] for better results
- 🔧 **Start simple:** Test with 15s duration, then increase later

🔧 Your First 10 Prompts to Try

1. "Vinahouse, Piano, Emotional, Sad, Slow tempo, Clean mixing"
2. "Vietnamese Folk Pop, Acoustic Guitar, Sentimental, Hopeful"
3. "Lofi Hip Hop, Chillout, Relaxing, Night Vibes"
4. "Ballad, Strings, Powerful, Epic, Cinematic"
5. "Upbeat Pop, Synth, High Energy, Dance Club"
6. "Jazz Standard, Piano, Smooth, Romantic"
7. "Electronic Music, Synthesizer, Dark, Mysterious"
8. "Acoustic Indie, Guitar, Melancholic, Beautiful"
9. "Orchestral, Dramatic, Building Crescendo"
10. "Lo-Fi Bedroom Pop, Samples, Dreamy, Nostalgic"

🔧 Next Steps

After Getting Comfortable:

1. **Learn all 7 modes** - each has unique use cases
2. **Experiment with Lyrics** - structure songs properly for accuracy
3. **Try Base Model** - higher quality for final productions
4. **Extract Stems** - use stem separation for remixing
5. **Master Advanced Settings** - seed, steps, ODE vs SDE

Documentation:

- **Full Guide (Vietnamese):** See ACE_Step_Full_Guide.md
- **ACE-Step GitHub:** <https://github.com/ace-step/ACE-Step-1.5>
- **REAPER Wiki:** <https://forum.cockos.com/>

🔧 Success Checklist

- Git installed & working
- Backend installed at D:\ACE-Step-Project\ACE-Step-1.5\
- Models downloaded (or auto-downloading)
- Server running on http://127.0.0.1:8001
- GUI script in REAPER Scripts folder
- Generated first track successfully
- Heard output in REAPER timeline
- GUI language set to your preference
- Advanced settings explored
- Ready to create music!

📁 Common Workflows

Workflow A: Quick Demo (5 minutes)

1. Open GUI
2. Enter Prompt (use one of 10 examples above)
3. Duration: 15s
4. Click Generate
5. Wait 30-60s
6. Listen to result

Workflow B: Song with Lyrics (15 minutes)

1. Write lyrics in structured format
2. Paste into GUI
3. Write specific Prompt for vocal style
4. Generate (40-120s)
5. Post-process in REAPER (add effects, adjust volume)
6. Export

Workflow C: Stem Extraction (20 minutes)

1. Import audio file
2. Mode: Stem Extractor
3. Select stems to extract
4. Generate (50s × number of stems)
5. Edit each stem separately
6. Recompose or use in remixes

📁 Quick Support

Problem: Server won't start → Check: Is Python installed? (uv install should have done this)

Problem: GPU not detected → Check: `nvidia-smi` command works?

Problem: Model path errors → Check: Do folders exist at `D:\ACE-Step-Project\ACE-Step-1.5\checkpoints\` ?

Problem: REAPER crashes → Try: Update REAPER to latest version

Problem: No output file created → Check: Is there 2-3GB free disk space?

📁 That's It!

You now have a complete AI music generation setup inside REAPER.

Start making music!

Quick Start Complete:

- ✓ Server running
- ✓ GUI ready
- ✓ First track generated
- ✓ Ready for more!

Next: Explore the 7 modes and create your masterpiece.

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Enjoy creating! 🎨